01 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Clear messages, shared understanding

Use the CCEs to make direction usable at every level.

The approved CCE Administrative Directive applies to leadership written direction. All staff can use the same questions to understand an assignment, ask for a missing detail, or check a handoff. The tool does not add approval authority.

What to include

01	**What is changing or being asked** Name the audience, the action, and its deadline or start date. Separate a date for sharing information from a date for doing the work.
02	**Why / Why it is changing** Give the purpose or problem being addressed. “Because management asked” does not explain why the work matters.
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Separate the work owner from the decision owner. Identify what the reader may decide and what needs another authorized person.
04	**What is not changing** Name the duties, service expectations, rules, or approval routes that remain. Do not call an unconfirmed detail “unchanged.”
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Name who receives questions and the response expectation. For escalated questions, give an answer or a named owner within two working days and a next update when needed.
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** When a supporting source exists, identify the current document, version, and verified location. When none applies, do not invent a source.

> **Use by content, not by channel**
> A short email, chat message, forward, or reminder still needs the applicable CCEs when it gives covered direction. A greeting or a reply that only confirms receipt does not.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

A complete message example

Illustrative example only. Replace the facts with your actual direction.

CCE	Example wording
1. Action	Service desk staff: check next week's proposed coverage and email conflicts to your supervisor by Thursday at noon.
2. Reason	We need to identify coverage gaps before the schedule is confirmed.
3. Owners	Staff check their availability. In this example, the supervisor holds confirmed authority to approve the unit's coverage plan.
4. Unchanged	Current assignments, service hours, leave approvals, and duties remain until an authorized change is confirmed.
5. Questions and reply	Send questions to your supervisor. Escalated questions receive an answer or named owner within two working days, with a next update if more time is needed.
6. Source	Use the current coverage schedule attached to the message. In actual work, include the approved attachment or verified location.

Build your next message

Use this space	Your notes
Action and timing	
Reason and owners	
What stays the same	
Question route and source	

Check understanding without blame

Ask: "To check that I explained this clearly, what will you do next?" Listen for the action, timing, and contact for help. Fix the message when the answer reveals a gap.

Keep the meaning intact: clearer words must not change a confirmed action, deadline, or decision owner.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.